



THE IMPACT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE USE ON WORKERS' WELL-BEING AND MENTAL HEALTH: A SYSTEMATIC REVIEW OF THE LITERATURE PROTOCOL

Lina Ramírez-Angel¹, Francisco Palencia-Sánchez², Martha Isabel Riaño-Casallas³

1. Facultad de Economía y Negocios, Universidad Anáhuac México, Ciudad de México, México. Lina_ramirez@anahuac.mx <https://orcid.org/0000-0003-1253-9292>
2. Departamento de Medicina Preventiva y Social, Facultad de Medicina, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana, Bogotá, Colombia, fpalencia@javeriana.edu.co <https://orcid.org/0000-0002-8126-7748>
3. Facultad de Ciencias Económicas, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Bogotá, Colombia, mirianoc@unal.edu.co <https://orcid.org/0000-0002-9384-1428>

REVIEW QUESTION

How have work practices and organizational processes that incorporate artificial intelligence affected the well-being and mental health of workers?

OBJECTIVE

This study aims to determine which work practices and organizational processes incorporate artificial intelligence and to assess the positive and negative impacts of their use on employees' well-being and mental health. This will be achieved through a systematic literature review with an emphasis on the field of management.

Keywords: Artificial intelligence, wellbeing and mental health.

INTRODUCTION

Recent reports from the ILO and WHO have revealed worrying figures regarding workers' mental health and well-being. In 2019, it was estimated that 15% of working-age adults suffered from some form of mental disorder (WHO, 2024). In terms of costs, depression and anxiety result in the loss annually of 12 billion workdays, which translates into nearly US\$ one trillion (ILO, 2023).

The COVID-19 pandemic brought with it a technological acceleration that impacted workers in different sectors, who migrated to virtuality without adequate preparation,



forcing them to quickly adjust to digital tools and to work remotely and in a hybrid manner. In recent years, with the development of new AI-based tools, workers once again find themselves needing to adapt and relearn how to use these tools and how to incorporate them into their work so as not to be left behind. But that's not all. AI has brought with it uncertainty and a rethinking of some jobs. A literature review (Cramarenco et al., 2023) mentions that the debate on job creation and destruction continues, as automation, robotics, and AI can affect routine and repetitive jobs, but can also generate emerging jobs that require new skills.

Uncertainty and a lack of technological skills can have an impact on workers' well-being, stress, and dissatisfaction, "The mismatch between an employee's skills and job-related skills might affect their well-being, the mismatch acting as a stressor, and leading to increased levels of dissatisfaction among employees" (Brun-Schammé & Rey, 2021). Similarly, continuous learning can affect well-being and work-life balance (Cramarenco et al., 2023).

However, AI can also bring benefits such as updating and training workers (adaptive behavior), which can lead to greater performance and satisfaction for them (Cramarenco et al., 2023). In the case of nurses, a study identified that "by automating repetitive chores and improving workload management, artificial intelligence (AI) can relieve mental health challenges faced by nurses and improve patient care." (Dailah et al., 2024, p. 1)

AI-powered tools such as chatbots have shown potential to reduce stress, anxiety, depression, and burnout in healthcare professionals (Baek et al., 2025). On the other hand, Natural Language Processing (NLP), AI-integrated Electronic Health Records (EHR), Machine Learning (ML), Clinical Decision Support Systems (CDSS), and Generative AI-driven tools such as ChatGPT, can help improve the mental health of healthcare workers (Dailah et al., 2024). It is even claimed that AI can also "streamlining workflows, reducing administrative burden, and improving job satisfaction among Healthcare workers". (Dailah et al., 2024, p. 1)

Although reviews have been conducted on the benefits and risks of AI use, mostly in the field of health, there is still a gap with regard to other contexts in the field of management. For this reason, this review article aims to address a broader perspective, covering different areas, sectors, organizations, contexts, and countries from the field of management.

In addition, authors such as (Cramarenco et al., 2023) propose further research into psychosomatic well-being for future studies, due to the potential transformations that



AI may generate in the labor market, from job requirements, work procedures, and task design to evaluation techniques, etc. For this reason, the objective of this systematic literature review is to determine which work practices and organizational processes incorporate artificial intelligence and to assess the positive and negative impacts of their use on employees' well-being and mental health. In this way, we seek to consolidate empirical studies that mention organizational practices and processes that use AI and their impact.

Considering the initial figures presented in the first paragraph of the introduction to this document, regarding the costs of mental health issues among workers and the impact this has on them, it is important for organizations to pay attention to the well-being of their employees, as this could increase their productivity, efficiency, satisfaction, technological skills, and performance, and also foster a good relationship with them (Cramarenco et al., 2023).

The use of AI in organizations can also help to shape and develop new jobs, replacing routine tasks with automation and developing new technical and social skills for workers. This article is also useful for higher education institutions, as it brings together the new practices, processes, and tools that they need to teach in order to adapt to the needs of the labor market and benefit workers.

INCLUSION CRITERIA

Population / Participants

Considering that AI is a technological tool that can be used in different functional areas, companies, and sectors, we selected workers from any area, company, or sector as our study population. This will allow us to identify the positive or negative impact of AI on workers' well-being and determine which organizational practices and processes are making use of AI. This also includes residents and interns in the healthcare sector, as in some countries they are considered workers and not students.

Phenomenon of interest

Organizational practices and processes that are making use of AI and the positive or negative impact these may have on the well-being, mental health, and happiness of workers. Articles that relate different terms related to AI such as generative AI, machine learning, artificial neural networks, chatbots, and automation.



Context

This study focuses on the organizational context to determine the practices and processes that make use of AI in any sector or profession, and how these have a positive or negative impact on the well-being, mental health, and happiness of workers. Therefore, articles that present a relationship between organizational practices or processes that make use of AI and one or more variables related to worker well-being will be included. Articles with a clinical, political, or social approach will not be considered.

Types of studies

Empirical studies, whether quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods, in English or Spanish, to determine what is being done in organizations and the impact on worker well-being. Literature review articles, conference papers, book chapters, or reflections on the subject will not be considered.

SEARCH STRATEGY

For the development of this paper, the SyReMa tool will be used as a methodological guide, which focuses on conducting systematic reviews of literature in administration (Riaño-Casallas & Rojas-Berrio, 2023), and it provides a checklist with the steps for selecting, analyzing, and evaluating existing literature on a topic. This will ensure the rigor and replicability of the study, meeting the minimum requirements to support its validity. The PRISMA guidelines (Tricco et al., 2018) will be considered for the synthesis and preparation of the review report.

The search strategy included, first, identifying the research question (PICOC: Problem, Intervention, Comparison, Outcome, and Context). Second, the main thesaurus associated with the research topic were identified. For this step, keywords from previous searches conducted in Scopus for each term individually, the autocomplete option, and EBSCO thesaurus were used, and ChatGPT was used to identify additional thesaurus. To construct the equations, several searches were performed, and finally, Scopus AI was used to refine the equation based on the research question.

Third, the databases in which the searches will be conducted are: Scopus, Web of Science (WOS), EBSCO host, and Emerald, considering the inclusion and exclusion criteria (the search strategy in each database is detailed in Appendix I). To identify seminal authors and texts, the WOS database will be loaded into Tree of Science, where



articles will be clarified into three groups: seminal articles (root), structural articles (stem), and more recent articles (leaves).

EVIDENCE SELECTION

Fourth, the Rayyan tool will be used for screening, which allows articles to be collected and information to be easily viewed. This platform automatically eliminates duplicate articles based on the title, author, and DOI, and a manual review will be conducted for verification purposes. After this, and considering the exclusion and inclusion criteria, two pairs of double-blind reviewers (FP and LM) will perform the screening based on the title and abstract. Articles in conflict will be settled by a third reviewer (MR).

ASSESSMENT OF METHODOLOGICAL QUALITY

Fifth, the full texts of the selected articles will be searched for and evaluated for quality and methodological rigor, to be finally added to the review (whether quantitative or qualitative studies). The reasons for excluding an article will be documented and presented in the PRISMA diagram along with the process performed above.

DATA EXTRACTION

Finally, the guidelines of the Joanna Briggs Institute will be considered for the extraction of information (Aromataris E et al., 2024)). The instrument for extracting information will allow data to be captured from both quantitative and qualitative studies (details in Appendix II).

DATA SYNTHESIS

A summary table will be created to synthesize the research results, which will include population, country, year, functional area in which it was applied, sector, etc.; organizational practices and processes using AI; and the impact on workers' well-being, mental health, and happiness. Based on this information, the findings will be discussed, comparing the results of the different authors. At the end of the paper, limitations and recommendations will be presented based on the literature review.

This article aims to contribute to organizational practice by promoting the use of AI in different processes and practices in different positions. It also seeks to promote the care and well-being of workers by identifying the positive and negative impact that the use of AI has on them. Likewise, it seeks to promote practices and processes that mitigate the negative impact and strengthen the positive elements of AI-based tools.



CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

The authors declare no institutional or personal conflicts of interest.

REFERENCES

- Aromataris E, Lockwood C, Porritt K, Pilla B, & Jordan Z, editors. (2024). *JBIM Manual for Evidence Synthesis*. <https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.46658/JBIMES-24-01>
- Baek, G., Cha, C., & Han, J. H. (2025). AI Chatbots for Psychological Health for Health Professionals: Scoping Review. In *JMIR Human Factors* (Vol. 12). JMIR Publications Inc. <https://doi.org/10.2196/67682>
- Brun-Schammé, A., & Rey, M. (2021). PRODUCTIVITY WORKING PAPERS A NEW APPROACH TO SKILLS MISMATCH. In *OECD Productivity Working Papers* (Vol. 24).
- Cramarencu, R. E., Burcă-Voicu, M. I., & Dabija, D. C. (2023). The impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on employees' skills and well-being in global labor markets: A systematic review. In *Oeconomia Copernicana* (Vol. 14, Issue 3, pp. 731–767). Institute of Economic Research. <https://doi.org/10.24136/oc.2023.022>
- Dailah, H. G., Koriri, M., Sabei, A., Kriry, T., & Zakri, M. (2024). Artificial Intelligence in Nursing: Technological Benefits to Nurse's Mental Health and Patient Care Quality. In *Healthcare (Switzerland)* (Vol. 12, Issue 24). Multidisciplinary Digital Publishing Institute (MDPI). <https://doi.org/10.3390/healthcare12242555>
- ILO. (2023). *La OMS y la OIT piden nuevas medidas para abordar los problemas de salud mental en el trabajo*. <https://www.ilo.org/es/resource/news/la-oms-y-la-oit-piden-nuevas-medidas-para-abordar-los-problemas-de-salud>
- Riaño-Casallas, M. I., & Rojas-Berrio, S. (2023). How to Report Systematic Literature Reviews in Management Using SyReMa. *Innovar*, 34(92). <https://doi.org/10.15446/innovar.v34n92.99156>
- Tricco, A. C., Lillie, E., Zarin, W., O'Brien, K. K., Colquhoun, H., Levac, D., Moher, D., Peters, M. D. J., Horsley, T., Weeks, L., Hempel, S., Akl, E. A., Chang, C., McGowan, J., Stewart, L., Hartling, L., Aldcroft, A., Wilson, M. G., Garritty, C., ... Straus, S. E. (2018). PRISMA extension for scoping reviews (PRISMA-ScR): Checklist and explanation. In *Annals of Internal Medicine* (Vol. 169, Issue 7, pp. 467–473). American College of Physicians. <https://doi.org/10.7326/M18-0850>



WHO. (2024). *La salud mental en el trabajo*. <https://www.who.int/es/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/mental-health-at-work>

APPENDICES

Appendix I: Search-strategy

Databa se	Date	Search ecuación	Restrictio ns	Numb er of article s retriv ed
Scopus	26/10/20 25	(TITLE (("artificial intelligence" OR "ai" OR "machine learning" OR "artificial neural networks" OR Chatbot OR ChatGPT OR "automation")) AND TITLE-ABS-KEY (("employ*" OR "work*" OR "staff" OR job OR management)) AND TITLE (("well-being" OR "wellbeing" OR "wellness" OR "emotional well-being" OR "mental well-being" OR "mental health" OR "psychological health" OR "happiness")) AND TITLE-ABS-KEY (("impact" OR "effect" OR "influence" OR "outcome"))) AND (LIMIT-TO (DOCTYPE , "ar")) AND (LIMIT-TO (LANGUAGE , "English")))	Document type: articles Language: English	217
Web of Science	26/10/25	Title: "artificial intelligence" OR "ai" OR "machine learning" OR "artificial neural networks" OR Chatbot OR ChatGPT OR "automation" Topic: "employ*" OR "work*" OR "staff" OR job OR management Title: "well-being" OR "wellbeing" OR "wellness" OR "emotional well-being" OR "mental well-being" OR "mental health" OR "psychological health" OR "happiness" Topic: "impact" OR "effect" OR "influence" OR "outcome"	Document types: Articles Languag es: English	163

		https://www.webofscience.com/wos/alldb/summary/c6eccc72-2630-4cc4-bac8-bb5fb63cf04a-0183e2c85c/relevance/1		
EBSCO Host	5/11/2025	TI ("artificial intelligence" OR "ai" OR "machine learning" OR "artificial neural networks" OR Chatbot OR ChatGPT OR "automation") AND AB ("employ*" OR "work*" OR "staff" OR job OR management) AND TI ("well-being" OR "wellbeing" OR "wellness" OR "emotional well-being" OR "mental well-being" OR "mental health" OR "psychological health" OR "happiness") AND AB ("impact" OR "effect" OR "influence" OR "outcome")	Academic publications Academic search Ultimate, business Source complete	81
Emerald	5/11/2025	"artificial intelligence" Filter Title AND "mental health" filter: ALL	+ journal article	102

Appendix II: Data extraction instrument

Citation details	Methodological Strategy (quantitative/qualitative)	Population and sector	Organizational practice or process using AI	Impact on well-being / mental health / happiness	Area of Approach (Psychology, HR, etc.)	Limitations and Future research